

How to Become an IAS Officer: Quick Facts

Eligibility	Citizen of India Candidates must be minimum 21 years of age Candidates must complete an undergraduate degree across any discipline with a minimum aggregate from a recognized institute.
Qualifications	Candidate must be graduate in any discipline
Starting Salary	INR 5.51 LPA
Highest Salary	INR 30 LPA

Qualification for IAS Officer

There are certain qualification requirements that must be fulfilled in order to become an IAS Officer which are discussed below for your reference.

Candidates must hold an undergraduate degree from a recognized institute across any discipline or equivalent degree.

Candidates who are in their final year or awaiting results are also eligible for UPSC Preliminary exams. Candidates must have proof that they have cleared their graduation and have to send it along with the application for the mains exams.

Candidates having professional and technical qualifications which are recognized by the government are also eligible.

Medical students who are in their final year of MBBS, BHMS, BAMS, BDS etc and are yet to complete their internship are also eligible for UPSC prelims exams.

IAS Officer Eligibility Criteria

Almost every civil service aspirant in India dreams of being an IAS Officer. In order to do so, they must fulfill certain eligibility criteria to be able to take the UPSC exam that are discussed below.

The candidate must be a citizen of India or of Indian origin subject of Nepal, Bhutan or Tibet settled in India before 1st January, 1962.

Candidates must have completed 10+2 from a recognized board with minimum aggregate of 50% or above from a recognized board.

They must complete their graduation from a recognized college or university.

Aspiring candidates must be above 21 years and less than 32 years of age to be eligible to sit in the UPSC exam. However, this age criteria varies category wise.

Candidates who are in their final year of graduation or have completed their graduation are also eligible for appearing in UPSC prelims exams but when they clear the prelims exam, candidates have to send their provisional certificate along with application in order to appear for main examination.

IAS Age Limit for General

The table below shows the age limit of general category students in order to appear for UPSC Civil Services for your reference,

Criteria	Age limit
Minimum age	21 years
Maximum age limit	32 years

Number of Attempts

To become an IAS Officer, candidates need to clear the UPSC Exam. There are a number of attempts that are permissible depending upon the category. For better clearance in the regard, category wise dissection is made relating to the number of attempts.

Candidates cannot appear in the examination if they have exhausted their permissible limit.

Category	Number of A
General / Unreserved	6
Other Backward category	9
Scheduled Caste/Scheduled Tribes/ Physically disabled	No number

What Does an IAS Officer do

Being an IAS Officer is one the most sought after and respected professions of the country.

However, the life of an IAS Officer is not a bed of roses. There are many roles and responsibilities that an IAS Officer must fulfill. Some of these have been listed below:

Handling the tasks given by the government including framing, implementing and reviewing government policies.

Survey around the nearby areas under their jurisdiction to understand the lifestyle of rural people and ensure that they lead decent lives, if not comfortable.

They have to manage and allocate funds to various activities that have been disbursed by the central government.

Supervising and ensuring that all the policies of the government are being enforced properly.

They also have to be responsible in times of crisis and emergencies like any major accidents, natural disasters or riots in their area of jurisdiction and take immediate steps for relief activities.

Steps to Become IAS Officer

Becoming an IAS Officer requires a lot of hard work and patience. If the candidate has decided to become an IAS Officer, there are certain steps that need to be followed. Some of the important steps are discussed below for your reference,

Step 1: Making a decision: As it is very obvious that preparing for any government exam is a time consuming process and requires a lot of patience. Unlike other government exams, UPSC civil services examination is the toughest as it has 3 rounds and various other dimensions to it. If candidates aim to serve the nation and to bring positive change to the society, then this profession is the best. It is challenging and demanding but at the same time extremely satisfying and respectable.

Step 2: Complete Bachelor's degree: It is one of the mandatory requirements to pursue a bachelor's degree in any discipline such as arts, commerce, management studies, medical, journalism, engineering, etc. Candidates who are still in their final year are also eligible for appearing in prelims exam but they have to submit their pass certificate in order to appear for mains examinations (if they clear prelims).

Step 3 : Understand the exam pattern: It is extremely important for the candidate to understand the pattern and work on their timetable accordingly. There are three rounds to clear the UPSC exam. Let's discuss them one by one.

Round 1: Prelims- This round consists of 2 rounds- General Studies and CSAT of 200 marks each. The duration will be 2 hours each. The paper will consist of 100 and 80 questions respectively. Candidates need to score a minimum 33% in CSAT and required cut-off in GS paper, candidates will be eligible for UPSC Mains exam.

Round 2: UPSC Mains- Candidates have to appear for 9 descriptive papers which includes 4 general studies papers, 2 optional papers, 2 language papers (one English and one optional language). Language papers will be of 300 marks each and the remaining 7 papers will be of 250 marks each. The language papers are of qualifying nature and not counted for merit ranking.

Candidates need to choose optional subjects but it is advisable to check the syllabus before selecting optional subjects.

Round 3: UPSC Personality Test - In this final round, candidates will be interviewed by high ranking officers who will judge the candidates based on their knowledge, personality such as clarity of thoughts, presence of mind, general awareness, etc. After the interview final list will be released by UPSC.

Step 4: Start with the preparations: After assessing the exam pattern, candidates must prepare a timetable and allot time to each subject equally and extra time to the top subject that needs more attention. Make a dedicated strategy for each round along with daily newspapers, important changes made in law, become aware of national importance politically, economically and socially.

Step 5: Assess your course: It is very important that candidates must practice mock tests for both prelims and mains which will help candidates to analyze their weak areas, writing speed etc.

How to Become an IAS Officer in India

To become an IAS Officer in India, candidates need to work hard and thoroughly with the general knowledge to build a foundation. Candidates are required to complete 10+2 from a recognized board across any relevant discipline such as Arts, Science, Commerce etc. Majority of the candidates opt for Arts for pursuing civil services. Post clearing higher secondary, candidates must complete their graduation in any relevant disciplines such as arts, management studies, medical, engineering, journalism etc.

While in college, candidates can start their preparation. Candidates need to clear all the three stages of UPSC Civil service examination- prelims, mains and interview. After selection, candidates will be placed for training at LBSNAA, Mussoorie for 4 month training followed by Bharat Darshan and 1 year district training.

How to Become an IAS Officer After 12th

After class 12th, candidates need to start their preparations accordingly as to cover the entire syllabus, it might take 8 - 12 months or even more than that. It depends upon the capacity and hard work of candidates. The candidates need to be motivated to continue with their preparations.

Some of the points that must be kept be followed after completing class 12th to prepare for IAS examination

Candidates must enroll themselves for undergraduate programs in any discipline arts, management studies, medical, engineering, journalism etc.

Candidates must complete their graduation from a recognized college / university with minimum aggregate score of 50% or above

They must enroll for coaching to get proper direction relating to exam and pattern and how to study and from where to start. Coaching centers will provide proper guidance to the candidates. Candidates must read daily newspapers and weekly or monthly magazines to get updated with current happenings in the world

Candidates must fill up the UPSC CSE form in order to appear for the exam.

Candidates can also fill up the form to appear for the prelims exam.

Candidates must read NCERTs and choose their optional subjects and start preparing

It is advisable that since there are a limited number of attempts, candidates must not waste their attempts until they are fully prepared for the examination.

How to Prepare for IAS Exam

The actual time to prepare for IAS exams is usually around 8 - 12 months. But candidates have to make their mind and start their preparation so that the entire syllabus is prepared holistically. Pointed below are some basic steps that must be followed in order to prepare for Civil Services examination,

Step 1: Know about the exam - It is one of the most important step to understand about the exam including its syllabus, pattern etc. Candidates must prepare a chart of syllabus and paste them in their rooms so that they can have a look everyday and it will also be helpful in assessing the importance of the topic from examination point of view. Candidates must look at previous year papers everyday as it will help them in getting the idea about what topics are important and mostly asked and what type of questions are asked.

Step 2: Work on building a strong foundation - A strong hand on the topics from the very basic to advanced level is necessary . Candidates must always start with the basics, candidates must go through NCERTs thoroughly as it is the basic source of information and it will help to understand the subject that they are going to study in detail. So, it is extremely important that the candidate must kickstart with NCERTs while preparing for UPSC.

Step 3: Read Standard books - Now comes the most important discussion as to what books to read. Standard books include NCERTs, LUCENT, General Knowledge books, current affairs, newspapers, Verbal & Non- Verbal reasoning , CSAT Manual, MAThematics, English Grammar & Composition from Wren & Martin, Oxford World Atlas, International Relations and many more. NCERTs can be easily downloaded from the website as well.

Step 4 - Master the current affairs - current affairs is the most important part of the civil services exam. There may be directly asked current asked questions as well as long answer questions. Hence, it is most important to read the current affairs of the past 12- 18 months thoroughly . candidates can read newspapers and read monthly current affairs magazines. Candidates can also join the course for current affairs.

Step 5 - Mock Tests and Answer writing practice- It is extremely important for the candidates to solve mock paper and practice answer writing everyday . Mock test will help in analyzing the pattern and from what topics questions are mostly asked and will also help in self-assessing weak areas. Daily answer writing will help your answer writing perfecting answer writing techniques .

Selection and Training for IAS Officer

After clearing all the levels of exams , IAS Officers are first appointed as an Officer Trainee for 2 years. During this period, they will focus on personality development and technical upskilling before candidates join their respective cadres' Let's discuss in detail the selection and training process of IAS Officers.

Fresh recruits will be sent for a four- month foundation course at Lal Bahadur Shastri National Academy of Administration (LBSNAA).

Officer Trainees will be divided as per their services and are sent to designated training places. The training of IAS Officers is held at LBSNAA and it involves Bharat Darshan and District training.

The four month course at LBSNAA aims to incorporate a spirit of cooperation and coordination among different services.

After the induction program, candidates will be sent for Bharat Darshan to experience the rich cultural diversity and heritage and meet dignitaries including Hon'ble President of India. This also includes a week-long stint at Lok-Sabha Secretariat.

After Bharat Darshan, Candidates are posted in District for a year to study administrative setup in a district.

Perks of Being an IAS Officer

Other than enjoying power and high pay, an IAS Officer is entitled to several other facilities and perks. Some of the perks are discussed below for your reference,

Government accommodation with subsidy

Security including gunmen and other staff such as cook, helper, gardener, etc

Reimbursement of medical expenses.

Reimbursement of mobile, telephone, internet charges etc.

No Toll tax on government vehicles

No charges while staying on duty for staying at government hotels

Free transport facility while on duty

Monthly pension after retirement along with Provident fund, gratuity, etc.

Government cars along with drivers.

Salary of an IAS Officer

The IAS Officers are entitled to pay depending upon the pay commission. The basic pay of an entry-level IAS Officer is INR 56,100 exclusive of other perks and benefits. The total salary of an IAS Officer comprises basic pay, dearness allowance, travel allowance, house rent allowance, etc.

So, combining all the benefits, an IAS Officer is entitled to INR 1,32,000. After years of service and each promotion, the salary of an IAS Officer increases per month. The IAS salary per month includes DA which is 9% which leads to INR 2,50,000 + 9% per month which equals to INR 32.7 LPA.

There are several allowances and components in addition to basic salary. The HRA allowance is 24%, 16% and 8% as per 7th pay commission norms. This HRA is decided on the basis of city category such as:

Class X - 8 cities only - 24% HRA Chennai, Bangalore, Hyderabad, Delhi, Mumbai, Kolkata, Ahmedabad, Pune.

Class Y - Around 100 towns (with a population above 5 Lakhs)- 16% HRA

Class Z - Rural Areas - 8% HRA.

Tabulated below is the monthly salary of an IAS Officer based on their post/designation for your reference,

Designation	Average Salary
Sub-Divisional Magistrate (SDM) & SDO	56,100 - 1,50,000
Sub-Collector (2 years after probation)	56,100 - 1,50,000
District Magistrate (DM)	56,100 - 1,50,000
Secretary (Minister)	1,50,000 - 2,50,000
Chief Secretary (States)	2,50,000
Union Secretary (Ministries of Government)	3,00,000
Cabinet Secretary of India	3,50,000

Key Components of BA Subjects

The BA Syllabus is a combination of core subjects, electives, and skill-based courses under the CBCS pattern. Core papers include subjects like English, History, Political Science, Economics, Sociology or local languages. Electives and discipline-specific electives provide flexibility and specialization for students. The **Ability Enhancement Courses** and Skill Enhancement Courses focus on developing communication, analytical, and employability skills. Usually, universities

offer projects, internships, and value-added courses to expose students to practical learning in their programs.

Components	Details
Core Courses	Discipline-specific foundational subjects
Elective Courses	Interest-based or Cross-disciplinary subjects
Skill Enhancement (SEC)	Communication, writing, digital skills, etc.
Ability Enhancement (AECC)	Environmental Science, Language
Discipline Specific Electives (DSE)	Higher-level specialisation subjects
Research or Project Work	A 4-year honors with a research track

BA Subjects Year-wise and Semester-wise

The BA Subjects is organized year- and semester-wise, and progressive learning is achieved each year. In Year 1, students take basic subjects like English or MIL (Modern Indian Language), introductory core papers, and Ability Enhancement courses. Year 2 consists of intermediate core subjects, Skill Enhancement courses, and generic electives. Year 3 consists of Discipline-Specific Electives, projects, and internships to deepen knowledge; it is common to see job postings and advertisements that require these experiences. In the final year (NEP 2020), students take advanced electives, major research projects, and open electives to prepare for further studies or employment.

BA Subjects for 1st Year (Semester 1 and 2)

Semester	Core Subjects	Ability/Skill Course
Semester 1	English / Modern Indian Language(MIL), Core Paper 1 & 2 (e.g., History-I, Pol. Sci.-I)	AECC – Environmental Studies, Communication Skills
Semester 2	English / MIL, Core Paper 3 & 4 (e.g., History-II, Pol. Sci.-II)	AECC – English/MIL Communication, Computer Skills

BA Subjects for 2nd Year (Semester 3 and 4)

Semester	Core Subjects	Skill/SEC Course
Semester 3	Core Paper 5 & 6 (e.g., Economics-I, Sociology-I)	AECC – Environmental Studies, Communication Skills
Semester 4	Core Paper 7 & 8(e.g., Economics-II, Sociology-II)	SEC-II (e.g., Digital Literacy, Translation Skills)

BA Subjects for 3rd Year (Semester 5 and 6)

Semester	Core Subjects	Project/Skill Course	Elective
Semester 5	DSE-I & DSE-II (Specialisation papers)	Research/Field Project	Generic Elective
Semester 6	DSE-III & DSE-IV	Internship/ Field Work	None

BA Subjects for 4th Year (Semester 7 and 8)

Semester	Core Subjects	Ability/Skill Course
Semester 7	DSE-V & DSE-VI (Advanced specialisation papers)	Research Proposal / Minor Project
Semester 8	DSE-VII & DSE-VIII	Dissertation / Major Research Work

Top BA Specialisations with Subjects

The syllabus of the BA specialisations aims to offer both theoretical understanding and practical knowledge across multiple disciplines. Although each specialisation has its unique pattern, most BA programmes involve core reading, elective modules, skill enhancement courses, and a research/project component. All of these subjects also involve field projects and case studies, as well as in-depth analytical assignments that contribute to students becoming thinkers and communicators.

Specialisation	Subjects
BA English	• British Literature (Medieval to Modern) • Indian Writing in English • Literary Theory and Criticism • POstcolonial Literature • Creative Writing
BA Political Science	• Political Theory • Indian Government and Constitution • International Relations • Political Thought (western+Indian) • Public Administration
BA Psychology	• Foundations of Psychology • Developmental Psychology • Abnormal Psychology • Research Methods and Statistics • Counselling and Therapy
BA History	• Ancient to Modern Indian History • World History • Art and Culture • Indian National Movement • Historic methods
BA Sociology	• Foundations of Sociology • Indian society • Social stratification • Sociological Thinkers • Social Research Methods
BA Economics	• Microeconomics and Macroeconomics • Indian Economy • Statistical Methods • Ecomomertics • Public Finance
BA Philosophy	• Indian and Western Philosophy • Logic and Reasoning • Ethics and Moral Philosophy • Metaphysics and Epistemology • Philosophy of Religion
BA Geography	• Physical Geography • Human Geography • Cartographic Techniques • Geography of India • Remote Sensing and GIS

BA Distance Education Program Structure

The syllabus for BA degrees by distance education is designed to replicate the standards of the traditional universities while allowing for the essential flexibility for self-directed learning. It includes foundational language subjects, core discipline-specific subjects, and options for

electives through humanities and social sciences. Subjects such as History, Political Science, Sociology, Economics, and English are usually offered. The university provides study materials in printed or electronic formats. Most distance BA-degree-granting institutions use the **CBCS (Choice Based Credit System)** and include assignments, term-end exams, and some institutions include project-based and practical work assessments.

Some of the top Open Universities that provide accessible and affordable open learning with a syllabus focused on the personal development of the students are mentioned below:

Open Universities	Details
IGNOU BA	- Semester system with credit-based modules - Subjects: English, Hindi, History, Political Science, Economics - Continuous Evaluation: Assignments, Term-End Exams - The NEP 2020-aligned 4-year structure has now been implemented
DU SOL BA	- BA Programme and BA Honours option available - Core+Elective+Skill Courses - Printed study materials + online resources+exams
YCMOU (Yashwantrao Chawan Maharashtra Open University)	- Foundation Courses: Marathi/English, General English - Core Subjects: History, Political Science, Sociology, Economics - Optional Papers: Environmental Science, Mass Communication, Public Administration
NSOU (Netaji Subhas Open University, West Bengal)	- Compulsory Subjects: English, Bengali, Environmental Science - Core Subjects: Political Science, Education, Philosophy - Electives: Journalism, Public Administration, Sociology - Assessment: Assignments, Term-end exams

Popular Books and Authors for BA Subjects

Students will engage with different academic texts, works of literature, theoretical readings, etc., as part of a standard BA program. These texts are related to the core of each subject; typical sections of syllabi will both recommend an introduction to theories and concepts and additional readings/further study. Although often in textbooks assigned for courses, reading lists are meant to help students develop critical thinking capacity, critical analytical thinking skills, and specific discipline content knowledge.

Subject	Book Title	Author
English	History of English Literature Literary Theory: An Introduction	Edward A. Schirmer
Political Science	An Introduction to Political Theory	O.P. Gaillard
History	Ancient India Modern India	R.S. Sharma
Psychology	Introduction to Psychology	Morgan Kaufmann
Sociology	Sociology: Themes and Perspectives	Haralam
Economics	Principles of Economics	N. Gregory Mankiw
Geography	Physical Geography	Savindra

Online Classes and Platforms for BA Subjects

Digital education is becoming increasingly easier to access, and BA students are starting to utilize more providers on various online platforms that host subject- or subject-matter-based classes, lectures, and tutorials. These new, immersive resources compliment the university

course syllabus, providing students with visually aided and interactive ways to better understand subject matter expertise.

It ranges from government backed portals to popular educational channels where the students can access tutorials at their own pace, revisit parts to grasp concepts, primarily while engaging in their course studies. Many of these learning platforms are free or low-cost options available to many learners, providing more flexible, quality leveraging learning environments for all.

Platform	Type of Content	Subjects Covered
SWAYAM (Government of India)	Full online courses with certification	History, Political Science, English, Sociology, Economics, etc.
NPTEL	Video lectures by IITs/IISc	Humanities, Social Sciences, Economics, Literature
YouTube (Educational Channels)	Free video tutorials	All Major BA Subjects
Unacademy	Live+ recorded classes	Polity, History, Sociology, Current Affairs
Coursera/edX	Academic courses (global)	Literature, Psychology, Sociology, History

Q1

What are the subjects in UPSC?

UPSC syllabus has mentioned different subjects under headings from GS-I to GS-IV. GS Paper 1 has History, Geography and Indian Society as main subjects; GS Paper 2 has Indian Polity, Governance, Constitution, and International Relations; GS Paper 3 has Indian Economy, Science & Technology, Agriculture, Environment as important subjects while GS Paper 4 has Ethics, Integrity and Aptitude.

Q2

What is the fee of UPSC application form?

Candidates have to pay Rs. 100 for an application form. There is an exemption for SC/ST/PH categories and female candidates. Learn more about it at the [UPSC Online Registration Application Form](#) page.

Q3

Is IAS syllabus tough?

Known as one of the toughest examinations of the country, Civil Services Examination has a comprehensive syllabus. The UPSC syllabus is designed in such a way that it tests candidates' knowledge, not in one but multiple areas of interest. Given the length and breadth of the IAS syllabus, it is usually considered to be on the tough end. However, with a proper strategy, it can be covered in a due span of time. Read more about the [IAS Exam Strategy](#) in the linked article.

Q4

Does UPSC Syllabus PDF contain prelims and mains syllabus both?

Yes, the UPSC syllabus contains complete prelims, mains and optional subjects syllabus for the aspirants.

Q5

Can an aspirant download the UPSC Syllabus in Marathi?

IAS Syllabus is published in English/Hindi languages. One can download the official IAS Syllabus PDF in the same languages only.

UPSC Syllabus for CSE Prelims

IAS Prelims is the first stage of the Civil Services Examination. More than 11 lakhs candidates applied for [UPSC Prelims](#) in 2023 while approximately 10 lakh candidates applied for the same in 2022.

It is important to know the syllabus for IAS Prelims as it is the screening test that qualifies candidates for the next stage, i.e. Mains. All [UPSC Exam](#) aspirants must familiarise themselves with the exam pattern and IAS Exam syllabus first, and then move on with the preparation. Aspirants preparing for UPSC 2024 must start preparing for the Civil Services exam in February 2023. One year of preparation is a must thing if aspirants want to score well in UPSC 2024 exam. This timeline of almost a year is crucial if you want to have a planned and smooth preparation phase where you can strengthen your concepts and clarify all doubts related to topics.

Exam Pattern & Syllabus for UPSC Prelims	
Two Compulsory Papers	General Studies Paper-I
	General Studies Paper-II (CSAT)
Number of Questions asked in GS Paper-I	100
Number of Questions asked in CSAT	80
Total Number of Marks	400; - GS Paper-I – 200 Marks - CSAT – 200 Marks
Negative Marking	⅓ of the total marks allotted to the question will be deducted
Time Allotted	Two hours each; - GS Paper-I – 2 Hours (9:30 AM -11:30 AM) - CSAT – 2 Hours (2:30 PM – 4:30 PM)

The two papers of the IAS prelims are discussed in detail below:

- General Studies
 - The General Studies test is the first paper of the preliminary examination.
 - This test is intended to test the general awareness of a candidate in a wide range of subjects that include: **Indian Polity, Geography, History, Indian Economy, Science and Technology, Environment and Ecology, International Relations and associated [UPSC current affairs](#).**
- Civil Services Aptitude Test ([CSAT](#)) (Generally conducted between 2:30 PM and 04:30 PM)
 - This UPSC Prelims syllabus for CSAT intends to assess the aptitude of the candidate in solving 'Reasoning and Analytical' questions, apart from 'Reading Comprehension' and the occasionally asked 'Decision Making' questions.

- The 'Decision Making' based questions are generally exempt from negative marks.

To be noted:

- The preliminary examination is only meant for screening a candidate for the subsequent stages of the exam.
- The marks obtained in the Prelims will not be added up while arriving at the final rank list.

The subjects included in the prelims are common for all. However, there is an option to opt for a few subjects in the mains phase of the examination. Get the detailed list of [IAS Subjects](#) included in the syllabus for UPSC prelims and mains at the linked article.

UPSC Syllabus for GS Paper (Prelims Paper I)

- Current events of national and international importance.
- History of India and Indian National Movement.
- Indian and World Geography-Physical, Social, Economic Geography of India and the World.
- Indian Polity and Governance – Constitution, Political System, Panchayati Raj, Public Policy, Rights Issues, etc.
- Economic and Social Development – Sustainable Development, Poverty, Inclusion, Demographics, Social Sector initiatives, etc.
- General issues on Environmental Ecology, Biodiversity, and Climate Change – that do not require subject specialisation.
- General Science

UPSC Syllabus for CSAT Paper (Prelims Paper-II)

- Comprehension
- Interpersonal skills including communication skills
- Logical reasoning and analytical ability
- Decision-making and problem solving
- General mental ability
- Basic numeracy (numbers and their relations, orders of magnitude, etc.) (Class X level), Data interpretation (charts, graphs, tables, data sufficiency, etc. – Class X level)

UPSC Syllabus for Mains

IAS Mains Exam Pattern

Paper	Subject
Paper-I	Essay (can be written in the medium of the candidate's choice)
Paper-II	General Studies – I (Indian Heritage & Culture, History & Geography of the World & Society)
Paper-III	General Studies – II (Governance, Constitution, Polity, Social Justice & International Relations)
Paper-IV	General Studies – III (Technology, Economic Development, Biodiversity, Security & Disaster Man

Paper-V	General Studies – IV (Ethics, Integrity & Aptitude)
Paper-VI	Optional Subject – Paper I
Paper-VII	Optional Subject – Paper II

Must-Know Facts about UPSC Mains

- The Mains examination constitutes the 2nd phase of the Civil Services Examination. Only after successfully qualifying in the prelims exam would the candidates be allowed to write the IAS Mains.
- The Mains exam tests the candidate's academic talent in depth and his/her ability to present his/her understanding according to the requirements of the question in a time-bound manner.
- The UPSC Mains exam consists of 9 papers, out of which two are qualifying papers of 300 marks each.
- The two qualifying papers are:
 - Any Indian Language Paper
 - English Language Paper
- The papers on Essay, General Studies and Optional Subject of only such candidates who attain 25% marks in both the language papers as a minimum qualifying standard in these qualifying papers, will be taken cognizance of, for evaluation.
- In case a candidate does not qualify in these language papers, then the marks obtained by such candidates will not be considered or counted.

IAS Syllabus for UPSC Mains GS-I

General Studies-I is also called Paper-II of UPSC Mains. It covers – Indian Heritage and Culture, History and Geography of the World and Society. The detailed UPSC Syllabus for this paper is given below:

- Indian culture will cover the salient aspects of Art Forms, literature and Architecture from ancient to modern times.
- Modern Indian history from about the middle of the eighteenth century until the present – significant events, personalities, issues.
- The Freedom Struggle — its various stages and important contributors/contributions from different parts of the country.
- Post-independence consolidation and reorganization within the country.
- History of the world will include events from 18th century such as industrial revolution, world wars, redrawal of national boundaries, colonization, decolonization, political philosophies like communism, capitalism, socialism etc.— their forms and effect on the society.
- Salient features of Indian Society, Diversity of India.
- Role of women and women's organization, population and associated issues, poverty and developmental issues, urbanization, their problems and their remedies.
- Effects of globalization on Indian society.
- Social empowerment, communalism, regionalism & secularism.
- Salient features of world's physical geography.

- Distribution of key natural resources across the world (including South Asia and the Indian sub-continent); factors responsible for the location of primary, secondary, and tertiary sector industries in various parts of the world (including India).
- Important Geophysical phenomena such as earthquakes, Tsunami, Volcanic activity, cyclone. etc., geographical features and their location-changes in critical geographical features (including water-bodies and ice-caps) and in flora and fauna and the effects of such changes.

IAS Syllabus for Mains GS-II

General Studies-II is also called Paper-III of UPSC Mains. It majorly covers Governance, Constitution, Polity, Social Justice and International relations. The detailed UPSC syllabus for this paper is given below:

- [Constitution of India](#) —historical underpinnings, evolution, features, amendments, significant provisions and basic structure.
- Functions and responsibilities of the Union and the States, issues and challenges pertaining to the federal structure, devolution of powers and finances up to local levels and challenges therein.
- Separation of powers between various organs dispute redressal mechanisms and institutions.
- Comparison of the Indian constitutional scheme with that of other countries.
- Parliament and State legislatures—structure, functioning, conduct of business, powers & privileges and issues arising out of these.
- Structure, organization and functioning of the Executive and the Judiciary—Ministries and Departments of the Government; pressure groups and formal/informal associations and their role in the Polity.
- Salient features of the Representation of People's Act.
- Appointment to various Constitutional posts, powers, functions and responsibilities of various Constitutional Bodies.
- Statutory, regulatory and various quasi-judicial bodies.
- Government policies and interventions for development in various sectors and issues arising out of their design and implementation.
- Development processes and the development industry —the role of NGOs, SHGs, various groups and associations, donors, charities, institutional and other stakeholders.
- Welfare schemes for vulnerable sections of the population by the Centre and States and the performance of these schemes; mechanisms, laws, institutions and Bodies constituted for the protection and betterment of these vulnerable sections.
- Issues relating to development and management of Social Sector/Services relating to Health, Education, Human Resources.
- Issues relating to poverty and hunger.
- Important aspects of governance, transparency and accountability, e-governance applications, models, successes, limitations, and potential; citizens charters, transparency & accountability and institutional and other measures.
- Role of civil services in a democracy.
- India and its neighbourhood- relations.
- Bilateral, regional and global groupings and agreements involving India and/or affecting India's interests.

- Effect of policies and politics of developed and developing countries on India's interests, Indian diaspora.
- Important International institutions, agencies and fora- their structure, mandate.

Get the [UPSC Mains GS Paper 2 Strategy](#) in the linked article.

IAS Syllabus for Mains GS-III

General Studies-III is also called Paper-IV of the UPSC Mains. The major topics covered are Technology, Economic Development, Biodiversity, Environment, Security and Disaster Management. The detailed UPSC syllabus for this paper is given below:

- [Indian Economy](#) and issues relating to planning, mobilization, of resources, growth, development and employment.
- Inclusive growth and issues arising from it.
- Government Budgeting.
- Major crops-cropping patterns in various parts of the country, – different types of irrigation and irrigation systems storage, transport and marketing of agricultural produce and issues and related constraints; e-technology in the aid of farmers.
- Issues related to direct and indirect farm subsidies and minimum support prices; Public Distribution System- objectives, functioning, limitations, revamping; issues of buffer stocks and food security; Technology missions; economics of animal-rearing.
- Food processing and related industries in India- scope' and significance, location, upstream and downstream requirements, supply chain management.
- Land reforms in India.
- Effects of liberalization on the economy, changes in industrial policy and their effects on industrial growth.
- Infrastructure: Energy, Ports, Roads, Airports, Railways etc.
- Investment models.
- Science and Technology- developments and their applications and effects in everyday life.
- Achievements of Indians in science & technology; indigenization of technology and developing new technology.
- Awareness in the fields of IT, Space, Computers, robotics, nano-technology, bio-technology and issues relating to intellectual property rights.
- Conservation, environmental pollution and degradation, environmental impact assessment.
- Disaster and disaster management.
- Linkages between development and spread of extremism.
- Role of external state and non-state actors in creating challenges to internal security.
- Challenges to internal security through communication networks, role of media and social networking sites in internal security challenges, basics of cyber security; money-laundering and its prevention.
- Security challenges and their management in border areas – linkages of organized crime with terrorism.
- Various Security forces and agencies and their mandate.

Get the [UPSC Mains GS Paper 3 Strategy](#) in the linked article.

IAS Syllabus for Mains GS-IV

General Studies Paper-IV is also called Paper-V of UPSC Mains. The major topics covered under it are Ethics, Integrity and Aptitude. This paper will include questions to test the candidates' attitude and approach to issues relating to integrity, probity in public life and his problem-

solving approach to various issues and conflicts faced by him in dealing with society. Questions may utilize the case study approach to determine these aspects. The following broad areas will be covered:

- Ethics and Human Interface: Essence, determinants and consequences of Ethics in-human actions; dimensions of ethics; ethics – in private and public relationships. Human Values – lessons from the lives and teachings of great leaders, reformers and administrators; role of family society and educational institutions in inculcating values.
- Attitude: content, structure, function; its influence and relation with thought and behaviour; moral and political attitudes; social influence and persuasion.
- Aptitude and foundational values for Civil Service, integrity, impartiality and non-partisanship, objectivity, dedication to public service, empathy, tolerance and compassion towards the weaker sections.
- Emotional intelligence-concepts, and their utilities and application in administration and governance.
- Contributions of moral thinkers and philosophers from India and the world.
- Public/Civil service values and Ethics in Public administration: Status and problems; ethical concerns and dilemmas in government and private institutions; laws, rules, regulations and conscience as sources of ethical guidance; accountability and ethical governance; strengthening of ethical and moral values in governance; ethical issues in international relations and funding; corporate governance.
- Probity in Governance: Concept of public service; Philosophical basis of governance and probity; Information sharing and transparency in government, Right to Information, Codes of Ethics, Codes of Conduct, Citizen's Charters, Work culture, Quality of service delivery, Utilization of public funds, challenges of corruption.
- Case Studies on the above issues.

Get the [UPSC Mains GS Paper 4 Strategy](#) in the linked article.

IAS Syllabus for Language and Essay Papers

- **Essay Paper – It is the Paper-I of UPSC Mains**

Candidates may be required to write essays on multiple topics. They will be expected to keep close to the subject of the essay to arrange their ideas in an orderly fashion and to write concisely. Credit will be given for effective and exact expression.